

VENKATA LAKSHMI (KIRAN) SUNIL-MANIKANDAN

SOFTWARE QUALITY ENGINEER

📍 TROY, MI | ✉ KIRANMAISUNIL@GMAIL.COM | 📞 331.230.1152

Summary Results-oriented Software Analyst with over 6 years of comprehensive experience in manual and automation testing. Proficient in testing web services (REST API), and experienced in executing scripted tests for API testing (Postman). Well-versed in Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) pipelines, driving seamless software delivery by aligning processes with Agile Scrum methodologies. Demonstrated Web and API testing expertise, with a proven ability to ensure high-quality software delivery and streamline testing processes. Cross-functional team player with strong communication skills and attention to detail.

Skills

Languages: Python, C, C++, Java
Tools: Jira, JUnit, Selenium, Fiddler, Postman, TestRail, Jenkins, GitHub, Azure, SQL
Web Technologies: HTML, XML, CSS, JavaScript
Browsers: Edge, IE, Chrome, Firefox, Safari
Platforms: Android, iOS, Windows
Expertise: Functional, Regression, Integration, Web Application, Mobile (Android/iOS), UAT, Telemetry Testing, API Testing

Experience **Post Graduate Program (PGP) Student, Extended Learning, Illinois Institute of Technology**
Troy, Michigan | Sep 2025 to Present

- Currently enrolled in the PGP - Generative AI & ML program offered by Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL. Completed coursework in Python Programming for AI & ML and Applied Machine Learning Techniques.
- This program also covers course/project work in Deep Learning and Neural Network Architectures, Natural Language Processing, Generative AI Essentials and Prompt Engineering, LLM-powered Application Development, Agentic AI, Autonomous AI Systems and AI-driven Software Engineering.

Career Break - Stay-at-home parent/caregiver

Canada/USA | Oct 2018 to Aug 2025

- Earned certifications in Software Testing, Automation Frameworks, and Python.
- Acquired knowledge and expertise in Generative AI, Python, and other emerging technologies
- Managed finance, coordinated appointments, and educational activities for kids.
- Provided caregiver support for an elderly family member.

Software QA Analyst/Tester III – Web Development Support, Contractor

ELECTRONIC ARTS (EA) GAMES, Burnaby, Canada | Aug 2015 – Sep 2018

- Designed comprehensive testing strategies for new and existing product features, ensuring seamless user experiences and functionality.
- Conducted diverse testing types: functional, regression, smoke, sanity, integration, UAT (acceptance testing), API testing (using Postman tool), and telemetry on web, mobile, and standalone applications.
- Managed end-to-end testing, including back-end and front-end processes, environment setup, and content management using Adobe Experience Manager (AEM).
- Optimized testing processes by identifying automation opportunities, minimizing manual efforts, and significantly improving operational efficiency.
- Worked closely with offshore teams across the US, Canada, and Asia throughout sprint cycles to coordinate production testing, resolve critical issues, and maintain alignment with sprint goals.
- Delivered high-impact projects involving value-added features across web and mobile platforms.

- Played a pivotal role in ensuring UX quality for projects such as **Play First Trials and Two-Tiered Origin Access Subscriptions (Basic and Premier)**.
- Awarded “**QA of the month (Jan/16)**” for valuable contribution towards project success (**Origin Access and Play First trials**).
- Conducted extensive cross-browser testing (Safari, Chrome, Firefox, and Edge) and mobile OS testing (iOS, and Android).

Lecturer/Instructor, Department of Computer Science

VISAKHA GOVERNMENT DEGREE COLLEGE FOR WOMEN, Vizag, India | Jul 2007 – Apr 2009

- Taught undergraduate courses, including, but not limited to “Foundation of Software Testing,” “Java,” “C,” and “C++.”
- Managed 18 instructional contact hours per week.
- Supervised capstone student projects in Visual Basic (VB), Java, HTML, and MS SQL.
- Evaluated classwork, lab work, assignments and proctored final examinations.
- Contributed to curriculum development, college committees, and professional development initiatives.
- Supported recruitment of faculty members for the computer science department.
- Conducted Microsoft Office training for high school teachers and students.
- Proctored annual group-1 exams for the Andhra Pradesh state government.

Software Test Engineer/Support Engineer

MOVATE INC (CSS CORP), Chennai, India | Oct 2004 – Aug 2005

- Prepared, reviewed, and executed detailed test cases to ensure software quality.
- Documented and updated software bug reports for various firmware versions.
- Diagnosed and resolved technical issues and system conflicts for clients.
- Delivered ongoing training sessions on product updates and new features.
- Conducted testing and troubleshooting for Linksys wireless products, including routers, access points, switches, bridges, and print-servers, via phone and remote desktop support.
- Performed compatibility testing on 802.11 b/a/g devices and firmware versions to ensure optimal performance.

Lecturer/Instructor, Department of Computer Science

ASD GOVERNMENT COLLEGE FOR WOMEN, Kakinada, India | Jul 2004 – Sep 2004

- Taught undergraduate level courses for 1st and 2nd year students and managed approximately 12 instructional contact hours per week.
- Taught key subjects including, but not limited to, “COBOL,” “DBMS,” “C,” “C++,” and “BASIC.”
- Assessed students’ classwork, laboratory work, and assignments while proctoring final examinations.
- Oversaw computer science lab operations, including software installations and equipment upgrades.
- Contributed to departmental and college governance initiatives to maintain university accreditation standards.

Education	Post Graduate Program (PGP), Gen AI & ML , Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL (in-progress) Master of Science (MS), Computer Science , Andhra University, Vizag, India Bachelor of Science (BS), Computer Science , Andhra University, Vizag, India
Certification	Building Test Automation Using Selenium & Test-NG , University of Minnesota, USA, 2024 Software Testing & Automation , University of Minnesota, USA, 2023 QA and Software Testing , British Columbia Institute of Technology, Canada, 2015
US Work Authorization	TN Visa (Canadian Citizen); employer sponsorship is not required.